

VariCAD 8.2-0.4

Designs on you

VariCAD 8.2-0.4 is a fast, compact and economical mechanical CAD package featuring true 3D modelling, solids and spatial analysis, 2D to 3D and 3D to 2D projection and extrusion, parametric symbol and mechanical part libraries and surface development utilities. It can be installed as a stand-alone application or on a server and networked in peer-to-peer and client-server configurations.

Most functions are presented as icons and also in the menu bars. When working in a networked environment, each user can customise the menus and icons according to their liking.

The software imports and exports common CAD file types (DWB, DWG, DXF and IGES). The files can be con-

verted individually or as whole directories. You can also use file name filters. Thus, you can transfer a whole drawing documentation using one command line.

For a high price of Rs 19,950, it delivers a strong value, though the learning curve is rather steep. However, the software provides tool tips and well-crafted samples of program features to make the learning curve easier. The application is also demanding on your system—make sure you have the requisite hardware to work smoothly with this application.

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium II processor, 128 MB RAM, 16 MB graphics card with hardware support for OpenGL graphics

VariCAD 8.2-0.4	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 19,950
Contact: G T Enterprises
Phone: 080-660 6093
Fax: 080-633 1047
E-mail: gtcadrom@vsnl.com



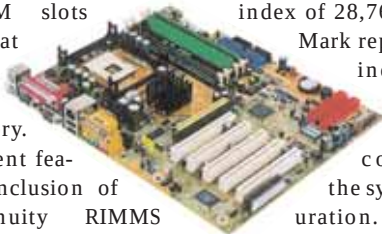
DFI NT72-SA Motherboard

All aboard the DFI express

DFI's NT72-SA motherboard aims to provide an RDRAM and RAID solution at a reasonable price, utilising the Intel 850E chipset. There are four RDRAM slots (RIMMs) that can support 2 GB of system memory. One convenient feature is the inclusion of two Continuity RIMMS (CRIMMS). Another distinguishing feature is the two-channel onboard Promise ATA RAID controller that supports RAID 0 (striping) or RAID 1

(mirroring) modes.

In the benchmarking tests, the board performed well in data transfer tests. SiSoft Sandra 2003 Pro reported a disk index of 28,766, while PC Mark reported a disk index of 972. This is pretty good considering the system configuration. If you use the RAID controllers, you can expect the indices to be better still. The benchmarks also reported a sequential read time of 42 MBps, ran-



dom read time of 7 MBps, sequential write speed of 41 MBps, and random write speed of 10 MBps. HDTach confirmed this with a maximum read speed of 44.6 MBps, utilising only 9.5 per cent of the CPU.

The *Quake III Arena* test saw an fps of 285.8 in normal mode and 281.9 in high quality mode, but dropped to 232 fps in maximum quality settings. The system took 97.54 seconds to convert a 52 MB MPEG file into the DivX format. The real attraction of the DFI is its integra-

Price: Rs 7,950
Contact: Zeta Technologies
Phone: 022-2410 2288
Fax: 022-24102277
E-mail: tejas@zetaindia.com
Web site: www.zetaindia.com

tion of onboard RAID and an RDRAM solution, and the price tag of Rs 7,950 seems justified.

SPECIFICATIONS

Two-channel audio codec (but no onboard graphics); integrated Ethernet controller; AGP 4x slot; five PCI slots; one CNR slot; two PS/2, two serial, one parallel port and two USB ports (expandable to 4), connector for optional IrDA interface; the RAID controller and driver CD; three IDE ATA/100 cables, floppy disk cable, RAID driver floppy diskette and I/O shield

DFI NT72-SA Motherboard	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Creative NOMAD MuVo

Gypsy player

The MuVo portable MP3 player doubles up as a removable USB drive. It has a separate battery pack.

Installation is simple and Windows 98 detects the player and configures it as a removable drive. Windows Me and later versions do not require you to run the installation program.

The model that we tested had 64 MB of storage. This translates into slightly over an hour of playtime. It has a good power consumption and the battery held up even after 9 hours of use. Unfortunately though, it is not equipped to shuffle or program your playlist.

Another sore point was

the frequency response of the earphones—although high frequency reproduction was excellent, bass frequencies took a beating. Crank up the volume to the fullest and you get ear-splitting distortion-free sound.

The player doesn't have ID3 support or an LCD screen, something we've come to expect from an MP3 player.

The Creative NOMAD MuVo can dish out some pretty high decibels. The 64 MB version of the MuVo costs a whopping Rs 11,299.

SPECIFICATIONS

64 MB internal memory, neck strap, earphones, manual, driver CD, battery pack, USB interface

Creative NOMAD MuVo	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 11,299
Contact: Cyberstar
Phone: 022-26556178
Fax: 022-2655 6181
E-mail: sushilb@cyberstarin.net
Web site: asia.creative.com

